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Newsom signs legislation to protect worshippers

Law restricts protesters; state security available

By Lia Russell
The Sacramento Bee

SACRAMENTO, Calif. — California now bans people from protesting, harassing or blocking people exiting or entering a religious facility within a certain radius, after Gov. Gavin Newsom signed two bills Friday that shore up state protections for religious worshippers.

Assembly Bill 2664 makes it illegal for a protester who is within 100 feet of a religious facility to approach someone who is within eight feet of an entrance or exit to petition or protest the person or intentionally harass, obstruct, threaten or intimidate them. The other bill Newsom signed, Assembly Bill 1836, expands the availability of state security grants to offsite celebrations like cultural and religious festivals, marches and LGBTQ pride events.

Newsom signed AB 2264 on Friday at the Wilshire Boulevard Temple in Los Angeles, where police arrested two people last December at a demonstration outside the synagogue because the temple was hosting a private event with a speaker from Elbit Systems, the Israeli military's largest defense contractor. The protesters were criticizing Elbit for manufacturing "weapons and technology that Israel uses against Palestinian civilians" and its contracts with U.S. border security agencies.

Gavin Newsom

"Every Californian should be able to walk into a synagogue, church, mosque or other house of worship without fear," Newsom said. "California is continuing to protect these organizations and the people they serve, and we're strengthening that work from the front door to expanding security resources to community events statewide."

AB 2264's sponsor, Assembly member Rebecca Bauer-Kahan, D-Orinda, thanked Newsom for creating a "safe bubble zone," noting that antisemitism has risen in recent years.

"For too long, too many people have been asked to accept fear as part of practicing their faith," she said. "As a Jewish woman and a mother, I know this is not abstract — one in four Jewish Americans now says they do not feel safe attending Jewish institutions."

Newsom's signing of AB 1836 sent a "clear message that Californians of all faiths and backgrounds should be able to gather, worship and celebrate without fear," according to its sponsor, Assembly member Jesse Gabriel, D-Encino. "Under Governor Newsom's leadership, California has been at the forefront of the fight against hate, and we are deeply grateful to him for signing this important new law."

The Legislative Jewish caucus, which Gabriel chairs and Bauer-Kahan is a member of, supported both bills, along with the Legislative LGBTQ caucus.

OBITUARIES

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Obituaries
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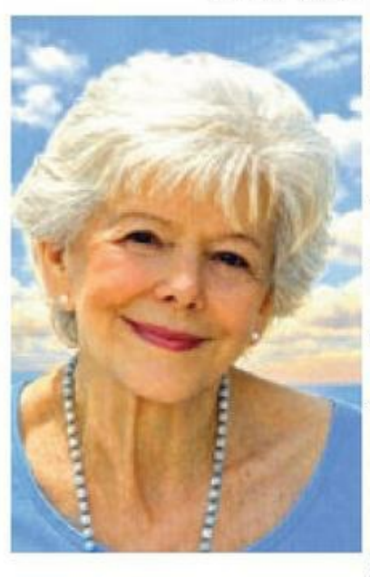
BEATRICE LOTT BAKER
1/3/1924 - 9/23/2026



Beatrice (Bea) Lott Baker was born January 3rd, 1924 in Stillwater, Minnesota. She moved to California in 1943, and then to Las Vegas in 1995. She is survived by her brother Jerry Lott, her two sons Jeffrey and Mark Baker, three grandsons Troy, Ryan, and Shane Baker; her daughter-in-law Janet Baker, and her sisters-in-law Bea Goop Lott and Anne Lott. Burial is at VA Cemetery.

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VICTORIA LEE RODRIGUES

Victoria "Vikki" Rodrigues, beloved daughter, sister, aunt, and friend, passed away peacefully on September 17, 2026, at the age of 74. She was born on July 21, 1952, in Henderson, Nevada, and spent her life in the Las Vegas community she loved.

Vikki was a proud graduate of St. Anne's Catholic Elementary School and Bishop Gorman High School. Her connection to Bishop Gorman continued throughout her life, as she dedicated an extraordinary 44 years to the school as its registrar. Her commitment, loyalty, and dedication touched generations of students, families, faculty, and staff. Bishop Gorman was not simply where Vikki worked_it was an important part of who she was.

Above all, Vikki treasured her family. She made it a priority to be present for all of her family's special occasions, celebrating life's milestones together and creating lasting memories. She was preceded in death by her parents, Caroline and Joseph Rodrigues; and her brothers, Danny and Tony Rodrigues. She is survived by her sister, Patti Puliz (Allen); her brother, Tommy Rodrigues (Alicia); sisters-in-law Mary and Connie; 11 nieces and nephews; and 16 great-nieces and great-nephews, all of whom held a special place in her heart.

Vikki will be remembered for her beautiful smile, quick wit, and wonderfully dry sense of humor. She had a way of making people laugh with a perfectly timed comment or a look that said everything without saying a word. She found great joy in playing cards and games, especially when surrounded by family and friends. Those who knew her will remember the laughter and memories she left behind.

Vikki lived a life of dedication, service, family, faith, and love. She will be deeply missed and forever remembered by the many people whose lives she touched.

A Memorial Service will be held on Friday, October 9, 2026 at 11:00 a.m. at Palm Mortuary, Downtown, 1325 No. Main St., Las Vegas

May she rest in eternal peace.

In lieu of flowers, please consider a donation to Bishop Gorman High School.

Sign guestbook at obituaries.reviewjournal.com

BEVERLY LONG

Beverly Long was born January 18, 1946, in Yuba City, CA. As a young woman, Beverly studied social work at Chico State University. She raised her family in Coalinga, CA, and later in Las Vegas, NV, where she made her home for over 45 years. While in Las Vegas, Beverly enjoyed a career in residential property management.

But more than anything, Beverly was someone you could count on. As a mom, sister, wife, and friend, she was the person who always had your back. She had a generous heart and a gift for making people feel cared for and welcome. When her children were young and raising families of their own, Beverly made sure there was always a place at her table. Sunday dinners and backyard barbecues (with bubbles and smores) were a regular tradition. No one ever left empty-handed, stocked with leftovers for the week ahead. That was Beverly — she loved her people and it showed!

Beverly's love of life and adventurous spirit were contagious. They both never seemed to fade. She loved to travel with her late husband, Donald Long, throughout Europe and Asia, often joined by their longtime group of friends. She was a very active member of the German American Social Club of Nevada, where she especially enjoyed volunteering and helping organize the City of Las Vegas Oktoberfest, GASCON annual memorial golf tournaments, and various other events for several years.

Beverly loved a good party and was often the one organizing the event and making sure everything was done just right. Her family affectionately called her "Bossy Bev," a nickname that perfectly captured her take-charge personality and ability to get things done. She never missed a good costume party and loved having fun with fashion. She was known for her love of anything that sparkled, especially her fabulous bling clothes, fingers and toes. Beverly was always up for an adventure including riding on the back of a Harley, ziplining, or taking an off-road ride through the mountains of Duck Creek Village, UT, one of the many places she loved. She lived life on her own terms and embraced it with enthusiasm, laughter, curiosity, and a willingness to try just about anything. After entering memory care, she often had her daughters or longtime caregiver, Margaret, take her to shop for gifts and "prizes" for fellow residents and their bingo games.

Beverly was preceded in death by her first husband and the father of her children, Raborn Owens; her second husband, Bill Bowman; and her later husband, Donald Long. She is survived by her four children, Sonya Neve, Roger Owens and his wife Carrie, Samantha Stadtlander and her husband Doug, and Seena Hyde and her husband Todd; her stepchildren, Rich Long and Amy Badain along with their spouses Stacy and Mark; Bill Bowman, Jr .; her grandchildren, Jamie Headley and her husband, Andy Headley; Jennifer Stadtlander, Roger Banuelos, Mitchell Stadtlander and his wife, Hannah Stadtlander; Bailee Dick and her husband, Cory Dick; and Hannah Benner and her husband, Steve Benner; Cameron Long, Natalie Long, Ally Badain, Bernie Badain, and Zach Badain; her great-grandchildren, Everett, Emerson, Leon and Charlotte; and her beloved sisters, Snooks Watkins, Jessie Miles, and Donna Dunn, along with their families.

Beverly leaves behind a loving family and many lifelong friends who will remember her for all her amazing qualities and will each have their own special story they can hold close to their hearts. She will forever be missed!

A celebration of Beverly's life will be held at the German American Social Club of Nevada on Friday, December 11, at 6:00 p.m.

Sign guestbook at www.reviewjournal.com/obituaries

California attorney general race repeats primary matchup

By Robert Salonga
The Mercury News

The attorney general race this November will be familiar to California voters, since it is a virtual re-run of the June primary that ended with Democratic incumbent Rob Bonta touting a near-insurmountable lead heading to the general election.

Bonta won the primary with 56.6 percent of the vote, an 18-point gap over Republican challenger, former Huntington Beach city attorney and U.S. Department of Justice attorney Michael Gates. Even though he received more than 50 percent, Bonta didn't win outright because the Attorney General's Office is subject to a mandatory general election under the "top-two" open primary system the state enacted in 2011.

Electoral trends in the state indicate Bonta, a former Alameda councilmember and East Bay Assemblymember, should pick up some of the Green Party vote, which comprised 5 percent of the primary turnout, and a majority of independent voters.

Bonta has offered plenty of red meat for Democratic voters — who hold a nearly 2-to-1 advantage in the state — by adding to the more than 80 lawsuits his office has filed against the Trump administration since 2025, and headlining high-wattage litigation like the $17 billion Meta social media addiction settlement and the contested Paramount-Warner Bros. merger.

Gates, who wants to focus on law and order without the drain of continually suing the Trump administration he once worked under, contends he has a winning path because of his competitive fundraising and what he believes will be a surge of Republicans showing up in the general election to approve a statewide voter ID ballot initiative.

Voter ID legislation, a cause Gates unsuccessfully pursued as the top attorney in Huntington Beach, will take the form of Proposition 39. The initiative seeks to require government-issued identification for in-person voting and put new restrictions on how mail-in ballots are validated. It aligns with a long-running political pursuit by President Donald Trump that has generally been stymied in courts.

Tribune News Service

Former Huntington Beach City Attorney Michael Gates, left, is running for California attorney general against incumbent Rob Bonta, right.

Prop. 39 is facing an uphill battle, with recent polling by the Public Policy Institute of California showing the initiative garnering 55 percent in opposition to 43 percent approval among likely voters. The University of California, Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies found 52 percent of likely voters opposing it versus 39 percent in favor in a September poll.

Gates continues to be competitive with Bonta in fundraising for the calendar year after officially joining the race in January. He has collected $1.76 million against Bonta's $1.31 million for the same period.

However, Bonta, who as the incumbent does not need to spend to widen his name recognition in the state, started with a much larger war chest. As of Sept. 19, his campaign reports having $6.34 million to spend versus Gates' ending cash total of just more than $336,000.

Gates launched his campaign about a year after serving as a deputy assistant U.S. attorney general in the Department of Justice. His political career is largely defined by his time as city attorney in Huntington Beach, when he pursued a city voter ID law and also challenged state-mandated home building requirements and the state's sanctuary law limiting local police cooperation with federal immigration enforcement.

In an interview with this news organization earlier this year, Bonta responded to Gates' criticisms about repeatedly suing the Trump administration by describing those efforts as a necessity to protect the state's federal funding independence on issues ranging from environmental regulation to immigrant relief. Bonta characterized Gates' policy positions as "MAGA culture war issues" that defy Californians' values.

Bonta was initially appointed as attorney general by Gov. Gavin Newsom in 2021 and then elected the following year. He opted against a gubernatorial run to replace Newsom in favor of seeking a second full, and final, term as the state's top law-enforcement officer.

IN MEMORIAM

In Loving Memory of
Monti Scott Deering

Aug 12, 1960 - Sept. 27, 2021

If Roses grow in Heaven
Lord, please pick a bunch for me.
Place them in my son's arms and tell
him they're from me.
Tell him that I love him and miss him,
and when he turns to smile, place a kiss
upon his cheek and hold him for a while.
Because remembering him is easy,
I do it every day, but there's an ache
within my heart that will never go away.

Love, Mom and brother Mitch

In Loving Memory of
— Linda J. Schmidt —
28 July 1950 - 29 September 2020
Friend, Wife, Mother, Grandmother, Nurse and Teacher.

Linda, it's been six years.
You had touched so many lives during your time here.
Your contributions are immeasurable.
Our family and those lives that you affected
will remember you for a very long time if not forever.
We're glad for every day, that we had you in our life.

Love you now and forever;
John, Jennifer, Roy, Illyana, Serena, Emilia, Susan, Rich and Bowie.
The pups miss you too: Harry, Peggy, Hudson and Lulu.

CITATION (APA STYLE)
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